

W6 Synthesis & Judgment

WHAT THIS FRAME MEANS

This is the most demanding frame. You are not just analyzing one dimension — you are bringing together multiple lines of reasoning and arriving at a defended conclusion. You acknowledge competing arguments, weigh them honestly, and explain why one position is more defensible than the others. A good synthesis does not ignore the other side — it engages it and then moves past it.

WHAT TO TRY

- Present at least two different frameworks or perspectives on the issue
- Acknowledge the strongest version of the opposing view
- Explain which position is more defensible and why — with specific reasoning
- Qualify your conclusion: what would change your judgment?

SENTENCE STARTERS

- "Taking together..., the most defensible position is..."
- "While it is true that..., the stronger argument is..."
- "Those who argue... are right that..., but they underestimate..."
- "On balance, the evidence points toward..., qualified by..."
- "The conclusion is defensible provided that..."

EXAMPLE IN ACTION

"Both sides of the algorithm transparency debate have merit. Advocates are right that hidden systems can embed bias without accountability. Critics are right that full transparency could expose proprietary systems to manipulation. On balance, the stronger position is mandatory transparency with regulatory oversight rather than full public disclosure — because the goal is accountability, not openness for its own sake. That conclusion holds as long as regulators have the technical capacity to interpret what they see."